

Food Sharing Initiatives in Brighton and Hove, England

Multimodal screening report based on 81 candidate URLs and supplied approximate coordinates · screened 15 August 2026

All candidate URLs were individually visited or attempted during screening. A candidate was retained only when the page itself, or a directly linked current service page reached from it, supported a genuine Brighton and Hove food-sharing activity; inaccessible exact pages, duplicates, non-FSIs, out-of-city material, ended activities and directory/policy pages were excluded. The map and district chart preserve the supplied coordinates rather than replacing them with newly geocoded points.



Community Kitchen
Brighton & Hove Food
Partnership Community Kitchen
Source page



BUCFP
Brighton Unemployed Centre
Families Project
Source page



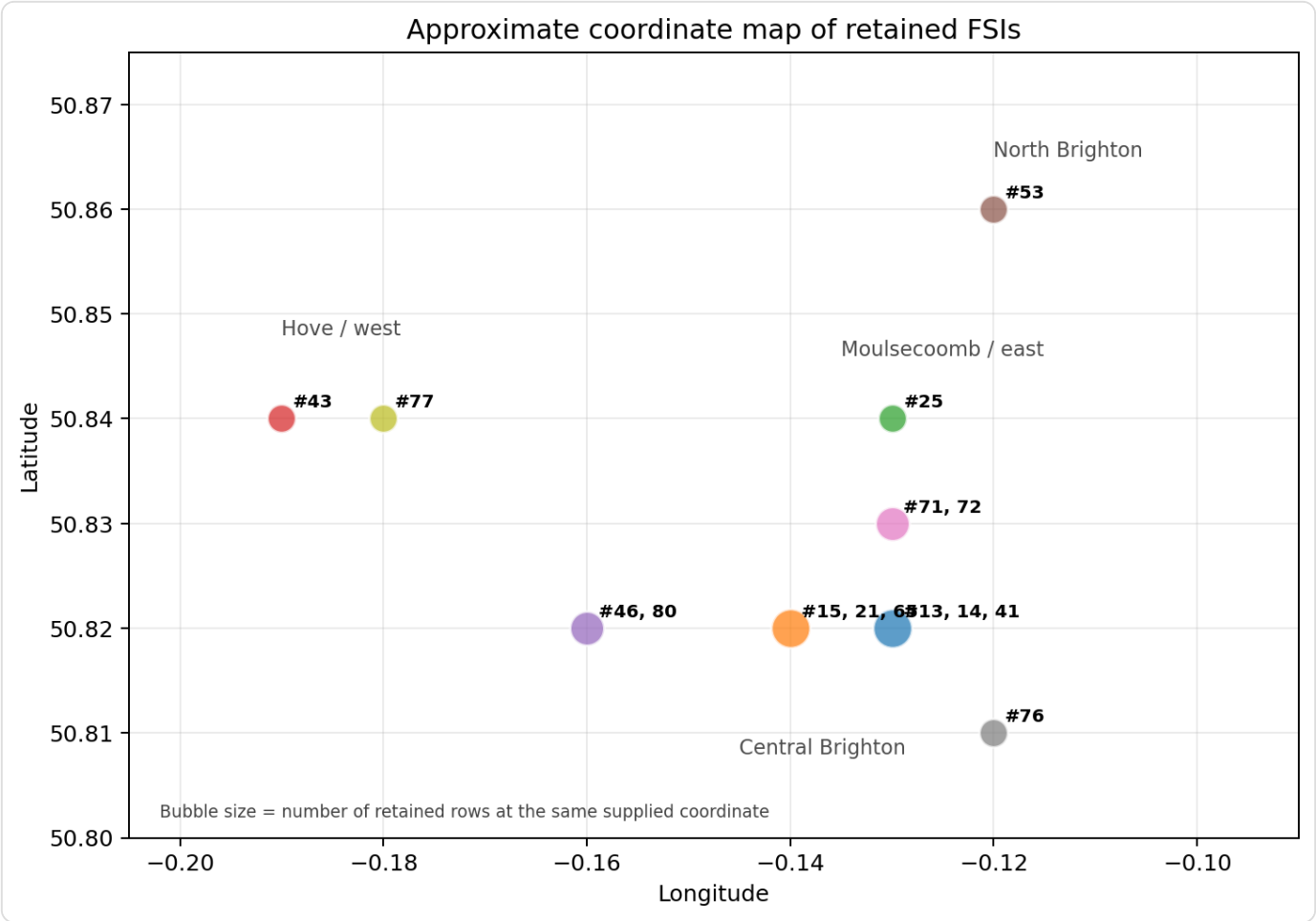
Moulsecoomb Forest Garden
Moulsecoomb Forest Garden
and Wildlife Project
Source page



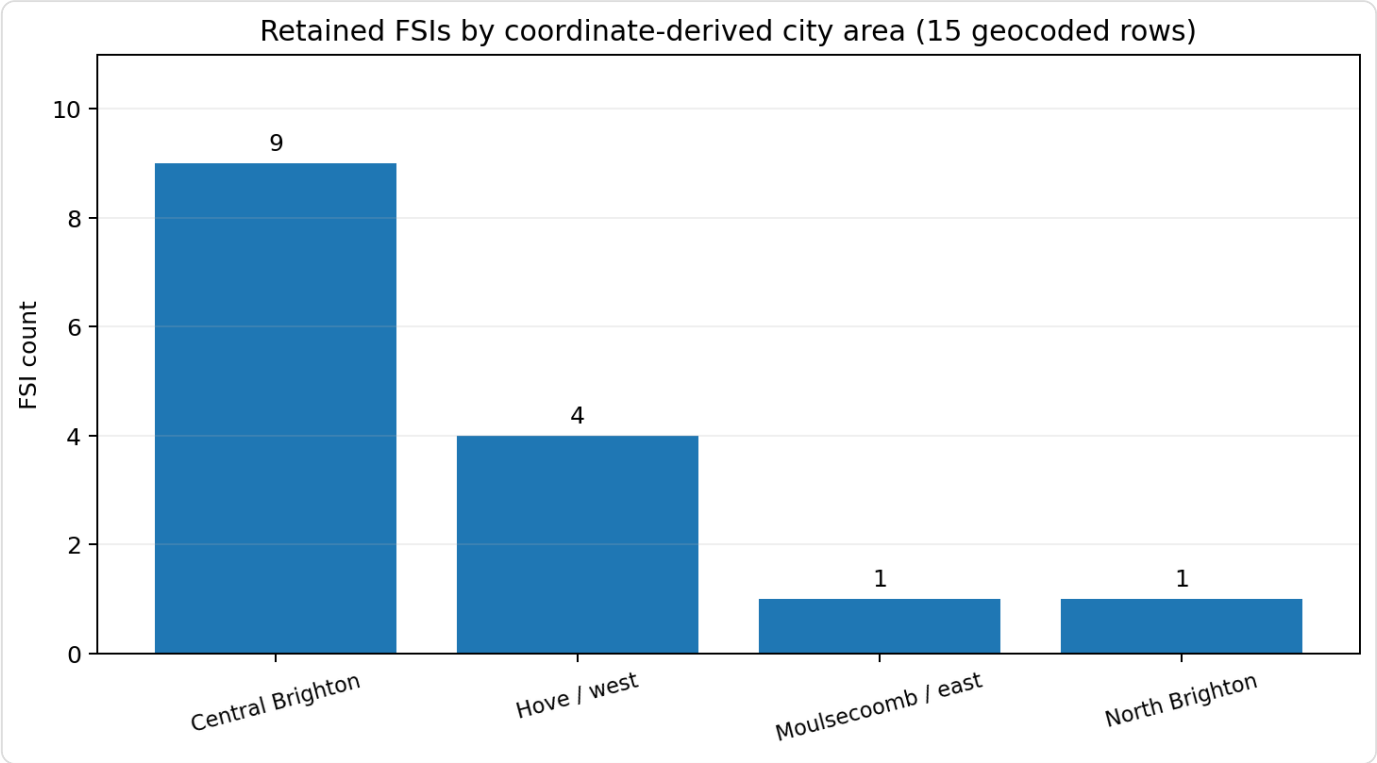
Weald Community Food Project
Weald Community Food Project
Source page

Geographic Distribution

Twenty-four of the 81 candidate URLs were retained as genuine Brighton and Hove food-sharing initiatives, and 15 of those retained rows contain both latitude and longitude in the supplied dataset. The complete coordinates show the largest plotted concentration in the central Brighton band around latitude 50.81–50.83 and longitude -0.14 to -0.12, where the candidate data place BUCFP, Brighton Women’s Centre, the Community Kitchen, the Clock Tower Sanctuary, Sussex Surplus and Voices in Exile among other retained records. Four complete-coordinate records fall in the broad Hove and western zone, including Hangleton & West Blatchington Food Bank, Holland Road Baptist Church and the Weald Community Food Project, although the candidate coordinates are approximate rather than administrative boundaries. East Brighton is represented by the East Brighton Food Co-operative and by the page-stated location of Fitzherbert Community Hub at 2 Bristol Road, while Sussex Surplus gives its address as Bristol Estate Community Hub, 146a Donald Hall Road. The northern edge of the plotted sample includes Old Boat Corner Community Centre at the candidate coordinate 50.86, -0.12, while Moulsecoomb Forest Garden identifies itself as a charity on the outskirts of Brighton and the MEP Community Garden operates at Roedale Valley Allotments.



Map uses the exact supplied coordinates for the 15 retained rows with both latitude and longitude. Repeated coordinates are aggregated into larger bubbles; row numbers refer to the Screening Ledger.



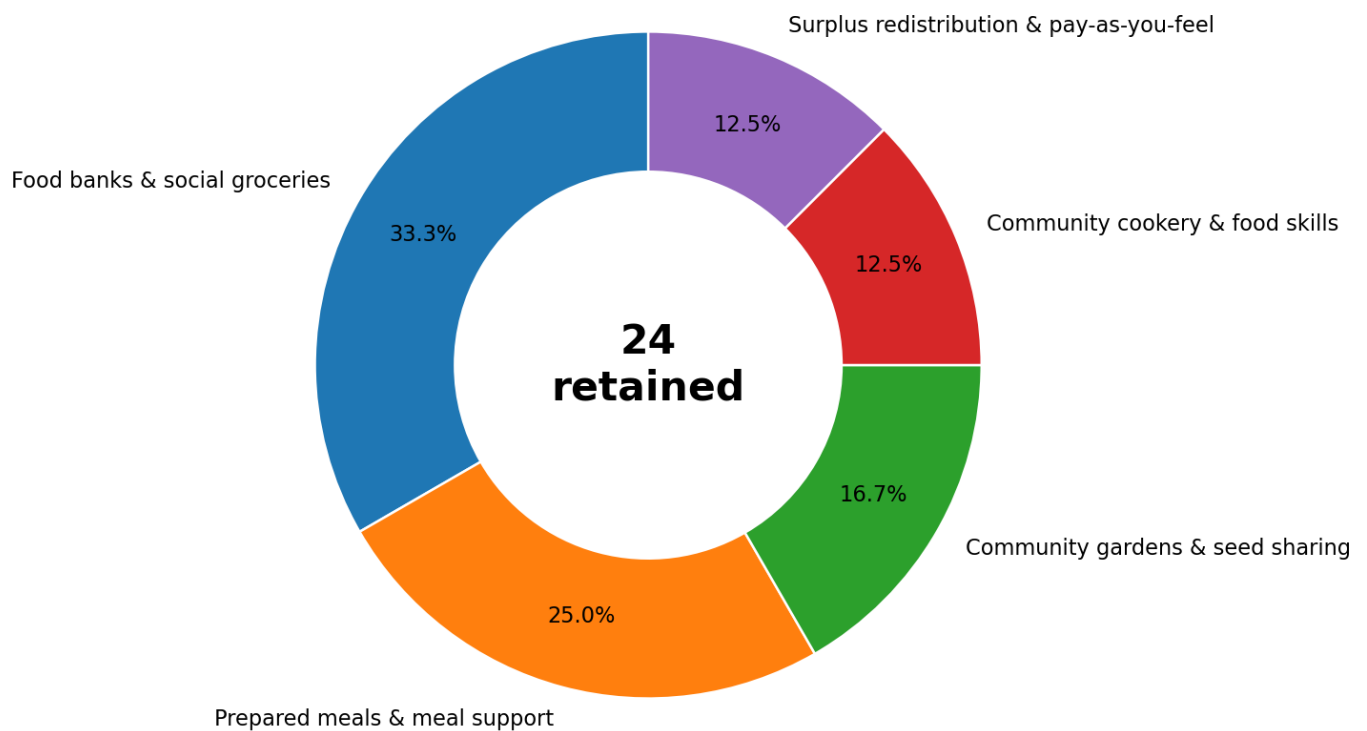
District bars use broad coordinate-derived zones because the input supplies no administrative boundaries. Nine retained rows without a complete coordinate pair are excluded from these bars.

Nine retained rows do not have a complete supplied coordinate pair, so they are not plotted as points on the map even when their webpages provide a textual location. The Real Junk Food Project is explicitly multi-site: its current locations page lists a weekday Bevendean hub, the Fitz Café, Hollingdean Community Centre, St Luke's Church Prestonville and other Brighton provision rather than a single address. Brighton & Hove Food Partnership's gardening programme is similarly distributed, with the Green Wellbeing Alliance page naming Preston Park community garden, Saunders Park edible garden and the Clubhouse on Saddlescombe Road. The mapped pattern therefore combines a strong central concentration with neighbourhood provision in Hove, East Brighton, Moulsecoomb and the northern part of the city, while several large programmes operate across more than one neighbourhood.

Types of Food Sharing Initiatives

For comparative coding, each retained URL was assigned one dominant FSI type even when the underlying service combines several forms of food support. Food banks, social groceries and comparable low-cost food shops are the largest group at 8 of 24 retained initiatives, or 33.3%, including Brighton Women's Centre's Cornershop, Hangleton & West Blatchington Food Bank, Impact Initiatives Food Services, Phoenix Food Shop, the Salvation Army Hove Food Bank, the Village Food Bank, Voices in Exile and the YMCA YAC Food Market. Prepared meals and meal-support services account for 6 of 24, or 25.0%, with BUCFP serving low-cost lunches, the Clock Tower Sanctuary providing a free hot lunch, East Brighton Food Co-operative delivering meals, Fitzherbert operating a community café, Holland Road running a Monday lunch club and Old Boat Corner combining meals with food parcels. Community gardens and seed-sharing projects account for 4 of 24, or 16.7%, represented by the Food Partnership's therapeutic gardens, Moulsecoomb Forest Garden, the MEP Community Garden and Seedy Sunday. Community cookery and food-skills projects account for 3 of 24, or 12.5%, comprising Bounceback Food's Brighton work, the Food Partnership Community Kitchen and Gem's Community Kitchen.

Retained FSI types (n=24)



Dominant-type coding of the 24 retained initiatives; percentages are calculated from the screened retained set.

Surplus redistribution and pay-as-you-feel provision account for the remaining 3 of 24, or 12.5%, through the Real Junk Food Project, Sussex Surplus and the Weald Community Food Project. Several retained initiatives cross these analytical categories: Old Boat Corner combines a pantry, pre-made meals and emergency parcels, while Fitzherbert includes a food bank, community café and garden on the same site. The YMCA page explicitly distinguishes its youth-led social grocery from a conventional food bank, explaining that paying customers and solidarity fees support free groceries for young people with emergency food needs. Seedy Sunday broadens the food-sharing ecosystem beyond immediate food aid because its seed-swap model circulates seeds and growing knowledge for future local food production, and its source page reports a historically large community gathering around that exchange.

Operational and Funding Models

The retained initiatives are predominantly delivered by charities, community interest companies, volunteer groups and nonprofit partnerships rather than by conventional commercial retailers. The Brighton & Hove Food Partnership Community Kitchen states that profits from paid classes, parties and venue hire fund community cookery work, and its community-cooking page lists both the National Lottery Community Fund and Brighton & Hove City Council among supporters. Brighton Women's Centre is a registered charity, and the current Cornershop page identifies Brighton & Hove City Council among the organisations funding or working in partnership with the service. Impact Initiatives is also a registered charity and says its Food Services team works closely with the City Council's Community Hub so residents can receive emergency on-the-day food parcels. Phoenix Food Shop describes itself as volunteer-run and says it is supported by the local council and nonprofit partners, making it a clear example of council-supported community delivery.

Hangleton & West Blatchington Food Bank is a registered charity that states it relies entirely on donations, funds and grants, while Old Boat Corner says its food project relies on donations from households and local businesses and partnerships with nonprofit organisations. The Real Junk Food Project operates as a community interest company whose pay-as-you-feel income is returned to project costs such as rent, fuel and vehicles rather than distributed as ordinary commercial profit. The Village Food Bank is also a community interest company and combines volunteer labour with donations that pay for storage, venue hire and essential items, while the Weald Community Food Project states that it is run entirely by volunteers. The operating landscape is therefore mixed: council-supported schemes coexist with charity-led services, volunteer-run projects and social-enterprise mechanisms, and the retained pages do not present any initiative as a purely government-run food distribution service.

Reach and Activity

The strongest quantified reach evidence comes from the Fitzherbert Community Hub, whose current anniversary story reports that the Real Junk Food Project café provided more than 21,000 pay-as-you-feel meals in 2024, averaging 1,676 meals per month. The Community Kitchen reports having hosted more than 1,000 community sessions for people in need, including people with dementia, disabilities, health conditions, low-income families, refugees and carers. The Village Food Bank states that it runs two sessions each month and supports between 35 and 55 households per session, with its current website also showing confirmed session dates for 2026. Brighton Women's Centre's 2018 relocation article recorded more than 100 women using the food bank in the preceding year, while its current Cornershop page shows a revised model opened on 1 July 2026 with appointments available once every two weeks. BUCFP's August 2026 page lists freshly cooked vegan lunch on Tuesdays, Thursdays and Fridays, a suggested £1 donation, one-off emergency parcels for people in crisis and Monday allotment sessions by booking.

The Clock Tower Sanctuary opens its day centre on five days each week and serves a free hot lunch at 12:30, alongside food parcels for young people aged 16 to 25 who are homeless or in insecure accommodation. The Weald Community Food Project distributes food on Thursday mornings and again on Sundays until supplies are gone, allowing anyone to take five items without questions and requesting a £1 voluntary contribution toward overheads. Hangleton & West Blatchington Food Bank operates by appointment every Wednesday from 12:00 to 14:00, whereas Holland Road's page combines a free Monday lunch, a regularly stocked food bank and a Friday affordable food hub with a £5 weekly membership fee. The YMCA YAC Food Market provides a different recurring model for 16-to-25-year-olds: the page lists 12 items for £5, access once per week and opening on Tuesdays, Wednesdays and Thursdays, with free groceries available for those in need.

Digital Presence and Accessibility

Most retained initiatives maintain dedicated webpages that state at least one practical access detail such as opening times, eligibility, booking arrangements, prices or contact routes. The Real Junk Food Project's current locations page gives core times for its Bevendean hub but tells users to check Facebook because opening times and daily food supply can vary. The Village Food Bank's website embeds social-media updates, provides a sign-up form and shows 2026 session information, while the service itself says there is no income check or referral barrier for its LGBTQ+ users. The Weald Community Food Project combines a WordPress information page with a Facebook presence and publishes its Thursday and Sunday opening pattern, volunteer email address and no-questions-asked access rule. Brighton Women's Centre's current Cornershop page provides a direct booking link, clear appointment frequency, prices of £3 for eight items or £5 for twelve, and the Globe House address.

Phoenix Food Shop's homepage is unusually explicit about a temporary operational change, stating that Wednesday sessions are currently at 20–22 Gloucester Place while Phoenix Community Centre is renovated and is expected to reopen in late autumn 2026. The Community Kitchen website combines class listings, volunteering information, contact details and its Queens Road address, while its community-cooking page documents the groups for whom free or subsidised activity is provided. A substantial share of candidate URLs could not be retained because the exact page returned an error, bot-interstitial or missing-page response during screening, even when the organisation name suggested a potentially relevant service. Other discarded URLs were resource directories, policy or research pages, or old event announcements, so their digital content can help people discover food support without constituting an initiative-specific page suitable for this FSI dataset.

Notable Initiatives

The Real Junk Food Project stands out for linking surplus interception with a pay-as-you-feel model across several neighbourhood venues, and its current FAQ says food is rescued directly from supermarkets, local shops, wholesalers and fields. Its partnership at Fitzherbert is especially notable because the hub combines the surplus-food café with a Monday food bank, a community garden growing vegetables and herbs for the kitchen, and after-school cookery activity in East Brighton. Brighton Women's Centre's food provision is notable for its 2026 shift to a supermarket-style Cornershop where women choose their own items, with the current page listing Monday and Wednesday opening from 10:00 to 12:00 at Globe House. The Village Food Bank is distinctive in serving low-income LGBTQ+ people and their dependents, and its page reports both two sessions per month and 35 to 55 households supported at each session. Weald Community Food Project is notable for explicitly connecting waste reduction with open access: volunteers collect short-dated supermarket food, receive a weekly FareShare delivery and redistribute fresh, ambient, chilled and frozen food plus surplus produce from allotment holders.

The Community Kitchen uses paid cookery activity to subsidise community sessions, and the Food Partnership reports more than 1,000 such sessions since the kitchen opened in May 2018. East Brighton Food Co-operative combines meal delivery with welfare visits and surplus redistribution, and its fundraising page quantifies its service in practical terms by stating that £4 covers one meal and £120 covers one month of meals, fruit and welfare visits for one vulnerable person. Moulsecoomb Forest Garden has unusual longevity among the growing projects: its site says the project was established in 1994, became a charity in 2005, welcomes people on Tuesday and Friday workdays and celebrated its thirtieth year in 2024. Seedy Sunday adds a city-scale seed-sharing institution to the retained set: the candidate article described attendance of roughly two to three thousand people, while current official pages confirm that the event ran in February 2026 and is scheduled again for February 2027.

Screening Ledger

Rows are presented in the exact order of the uploaded CSV. The reason column is intentionally blank for retained URLs and uses the requested short screening labels for discarded URLs.

No.	URL	Decision	Reason
1	https://restaurantsbrighton.co.uk/jobs/blog/the-real-junk-food-project	Retained	
2	https://opendocs.ids.ac.uk/articles/report/Strengthening_Dignified_and_Equitable_Access_to_Affordable_and_Healthy_Food_in_the_City_of_Brighton_Hove/27255228	Discarded	directory or policy page
3	https://www.alliancefordignifiedfoodsupport.org.uk/glossary	Discarded	directory or policy page
4	https://www.balfourprimary.co.uk/page/?title=The+Pantry&pid=208	Discarded	inaccessible
5	https://bouncebackfood.co.uk/brighton	Retained	
6	https://www.bhaf.org.uk/content/advice/gardening-advice-a-z/why-we-love-ground-beetles-and-other-curious-facts-compost-making-workshops-at-fork-and-dig-it	Discarded	inaccessible
7	https://www.brighton-hove.gov.uk/cost-living-support/help-food-meals-and-shopping/food-banks-community-food-hubs-and-low-cost-food	Discarded	directory or policy page
8	https://brightonhomeless.wordpress.com/2018/08/28/free-food-showers-laundry	Discarded	directory or policy page
9	https://communitysupportedagriculture.org.uk/farms/brighton-hove-sheepshare	Discarded	inaccessible
10	https://www.bcw.org.uk/	Discarded	not an FSI
11	https://brightonpermaculture.org.uk/saunders-park-community-orchard	Discarded	inaccessible
12	https://restaurantsbrighton.co.uk/brighton-hove-food-partnership	Discarded	duplicate
13	https://bucfp.org/	Retained	
14	https://womenscentre.org.uk/bwcs-foodbank-moves-location	Retained	
15	https://bhfood.org.uk/cookery-school	Retained	
16	https://covidbrightonhove.org.uk/help-directory/food-and-shopping	Discarded	directory or policy page
17	https://www.meetup.com/brighton-and-hove-organic-gardening-group-bhogg	Discarded	inaccessible
18	https://bhorganicgardeninggroup.org/2019/06/22/foraging-series-the-stanmer-scavenge	Discarded	activity ended
19	https://www.rottingdeanandsaltdeanlions.org.uk/coronavirus	Discarded	activity ended
20	https://forkanddigit.co.uk/csa-veg-share	Discarded	inaccessible
21	https://www.thects.org.uk/	Retained	
22	https://bhfood.org.uk/welcoming-refugees-to-the-community-kitchen	Discarded	duplicate
23	https://www.compostclub.online/	Discarded	outside the city
24	https://whitehawkallotments.org.uk/links	Discarded	directory or policy page
25	https://www.eastbrightonfoodcoop.uk/	Retained	
26	https://1space.eastsussex.gov.uk/Search?CategoryId=334&SM=ServiceSearch&UDG=True&SME=True	Discarded	directory or policy page
27	https://www.wearemanuel.com/care	Discarded	not an FSI
28	https://www.emmaus-international.org/en/membgroup/emmaus-brighton-hove	Discarded	not an FSI
29	https://bmecp.org.uk/bmecp-food-bank	Discarded	inaccessible
30	https://www.freshstartbrighton.org.uk/christmas-cheer.html	Discarded	activity ended
31	https://faresharesussexandsurrey.org.uk/contact	Discarded	not an FSI
32	https://fitzherbertcommunityhub.org.uk/	Retained	
33	https://www.foodandfriendship.org.uk/food	Discarded	not an FSI
34	https://www.foodmatters.org/blog/food-waste-to-food-use	Discarded	not an FSI
35	https://niwbh.org/project/food-deliveries	Discarded	inaccessible

No.	URL	Decision	Reason
36	https://foodcycle.org.uk/	Discarded	not an FSI
37	https://dykeroadpark.wordpress.com/community-vegetable-garden	Discarded	inaccessible
38	https://www.gemogston.com/community/gems-community-kitchen	Retained	
39	https://www.simpletix.com/e/get-growing-in-hollingdean-get-healthy-out-tickets-195862	Discarded	activity ended
40	https://www.goodgym.org/happenings/social-scrub-up-at-brighton-community-kitchen-feb65282-4b03-4952-82e5-887d6804818f	Discarded	activity ended
41	https://greenwellbeingalliance.org.uk/project/brighton-hove-food-partnership	Retained	
42	https://growinghollingdean.org.uk/2024/12/17/want-to-be-part-of-something-new-in-2025-help-plan-and-plant-edible-garden-beds-in-hollingdean-park	Discarded	activity ended
43	https://www.hangletonfoodbank.org/	Retained	
44	https://www.hasl.org.uk/local-sustainable-food	Discarded	directory or policy page
45	https://hanover-action.org.uk/home/actions-and-events	Discarded	inaccessible
46	https://www.hrbc.org.uk/socialaction	Retained	
47	https://impact-initiatives.org.uk/services/food-services	Retained	
48	https://www.infinityfoodsretail.coop/seedy-sunday-2022	Discarded	activity ended
49	https://www.lovefoodsharefood.org/	Discarded	inaccessible
50	https://lunchpositive.org/	Discarded	inaccessible
51	https://moulsecoombforestgarden.org/	Retained	
52	https://nurturethroughnature.org/	Discarded	inaccessible
53	https://theoldboat.co.uk/community-projects	Retained	
54	https://www.onegardenbrighton.com/community/volunteer	Discarded	inaccessible
55	https://about.openfoodnetwork.org.uk/sussex-grazed	Discarded	activity ended
56	https://www.plot22.org/who-we-are	Discarded	inaccessible
57	https://www.phoenixfood.org/	Retained	
58	https://realfarming.org/programmes/food-justice/ready-healthy-eat	Discarded	activity ended
59	https://www.sharingskills.co.uk/food/community-food-growing	Discarded	outside the city
60	https://www.seedsovereignty.info/gathering-the-seed-community-a-conversation-with-seedy-sunday	Retained	
61	https://www.stmatthiasbrighton.org/136/Help	Discarded	activity ended
62	https://www.stanfordjun.brighton-hove.sch.uk/brighton-hove/primary/stanford/site/pages/gardendiary	Discarded	not an FSI
63	https://community21.org/partners/resource/directory/food/9796	Discarded	directory or policy page
64	https://emmaus-europe.org/language/en/emmaus-brighton-hove-a-botanical-wonderland-in-portslade	Discarded	not an FSI
65	https://www.sussexsurplus.org/about	Retained	
66	https://www.sustainablefoodplaces.org/case_studies/1299	Discarded	directory or policy page
67	https://www.givefood.org.uk/needs/at/brighton/donationpoint/tesco-hove	Discarded	directory or policy page
68	https://thebiglemon.com/2014/04/28/help-the-homeless-fill-the-box	Discarded	activity ended
69	https://foodwastecollective.blogspot.com/	Discarded	inaccessible
70	https://mepbrighton.com/horticultural-skills	Retained	
71	https://www.salvationarmy.org.uk/hove	Retained	
72	https://www.thevillagefoodbank.org/	Retained	
73	https://www.tttb.org.uk/covid-19	Discarded	activity ended

No.	URL	Decision	Reason
74	https://togetherinsussex.org.uk/areas-of-work/food-poverty	Discarded	directory or policy page
75	https://www.ukharvest.org.uk/education/get-support/food-support	Discarded	directory or policy page
76	https://www.voicesinexile.org/	Retained	
77	https://wealdallotmentgardeners.home.blog/	Retained	
78	https://www.sussex.ics.nhs.uk/refugeehelp/weald-community-fridge	Discarded	inaccessible
79	https://womeninthefoodindustry.com/women-in-food-design-collaborate-to-support-nhs-lewes	Discarded	outside the city
80	https://www.ymcadlg.org/ymca-food-market-everything-you-need-to-know	Retained	
81	https://www.ymcadlg.org/ymca-yac-brighton-open-a-sustainable-food-market	Discarded	duplicate

Screening outcome: 24 of 81 URLs retained.

Image sources shown in the header are the initiative websites/pages themselves. Chart counts and percentages are derived only from the retained rows in this screening.